Pick the Smartest Method

Lesson 8 · Thursday, November 5, 2026 · Your task list says which page to do and when.

Part 1: Word Power

Circle the best word for each sentence.

1. Gobber looked at every box very closely. He _____ the work.

scrutinized | blundered | triumphed

2. Writing 7 × 8 = 54 is a careless _____.

method | blunder | valid

3. For 9 × 6, the _____ method is just knowing the fact.

optimal | deliberate | triumphant

4. Every partial product is right, so the answer is _____.

triumphant | valid | blunder

5. Use the word deliberate in a sentence about multiplying.

Part 2: Pick the tool

Circle the optimal method for each problem.

6. 9 × 7

Know the fact | Break apart | Area model

7. 15 × 6

Know the fact | Break apart | Area model

8. 283 × 4

Know the fact | Break apart | Area model

9. Solve #8 with an area model. Write the answer.

Part 3: Find the blunder

Find the blunder. Fix it and write the right answer.

10. Kai wrote: 76 × 8 = 560 + 42 = 602

11. Mira added 7 again and again for 16 × 7 and got 105.

Part 4: Word problems

Estimate first. Then solve. Show your boxes.

12. A Viking market has 26 stalls. Each stall sells 35 fish. How many fish? Estimate: between _____ and _____.

13. Hiccup has 500 coins. He buys 6 shields that cost 74 coins each. How many coins are left?

Part 5: Book corner

Answer in two complete sentences.

14. Has Hiccup been triumphant yet in the part you read? Use one detail from the book to prove your answer.

KCE PATHWAYS · GRADES 4–5 · UNIT 3: BUILDING THINGS · WEEK 12 · READING

Building Up Houston: Informative Writing, Paragraphs and Transitions

Name: _____ Date: _____

PRE-LESSON WARM-UP · DO THIS BEFORE YOUR COMPUTER LESSON

Pre-Lesson Warm-Up: Building a Paragraph

Before the lesson, show what you already know about how paragraphs are built. Do your best. It is fine to guess!

1. Which sentence would make the best TOPIC sentence for a paragraph about building on clay soil?

   Clay soil makes building a foundation tricky. | The crew eats lunch at noon. | My favorite color is brown.

2. Circle the transition word, then write its job (order, example, contrast, or effect): The rain lasted all day. As a result, the crew stayed home.

3. Cross out the sentence that does NOT belong: Cranes lift heavy loads. They can lift steel beams to the top floor. I like tacos. Some cranes are taller than the building.

4. Add the missing comma: Next the crew pours the concrete.

5. Review (Week 11): Which sentence is punctuated correctly?

   "Watch the crane," Andre said. | "Watch the crane." Andre said. | "Watch the crane", Andre said.

KCE PATHWAYS · GRADES 4–5 · UNIT 3: BUILDING THINGS · WEEK 12 · READING

Building Up Houston: Informative Writing, Paragraphs and Transitions

Name: _____ Date: _____

POST-LESSON CHALLENGE · DO THIS AFTER YOUR COMPUTER LESSON

Post-Lesson Challenge: Paragraph Builder

Now use everything you practiced today: topic sentences, supporting details, transition words, and concluding sentences.

1. Write the letters in the best order to make a paragraph: A. Next, they tie steel bars into grids. B. Building the frame takes teamwork. C. Finally, concrete is poured around the steel. D. First, workers set up the forms.

2. Fill in each blank with the best transition (however, for example, as a result): Houston gets strong storms. _____, builders install thick windows. Many workers help. _____, electricians run wires. Concrete cracks when stretched. _____, steel is strong when stretched.

3. Find the off-topic sentence and write a better supporting detail to replace it: Inspectors keep buildings safe. They check the foundation. My uncle has a red truck. They test the wiring.

KCE PATHWAYS · GRADES 4–5 · UNIT 3: BUILDING THINGS · WEEK 12 · READING

Building Up Houston: Informative Writing, Paragraphs and Transitions

Name: _____ Date: _____

POST-LESSON CHALLENGE · DO THIS AFTER YOUR COMPUTER LESSON · CONTINUED

Post-Lesson Challenge: Paragraph Builder

4 Rewrite with correct capitals and commas: first the crew in houston pours concrete. however the rain slows them down.

5 Writing: Write an informative paragraph (5 to 6 sentences) about a building, bridge, barn or other structure in your community. Include a topic sentence, at least three supporting details, at least two transition words, and a concluding sentence. Underline your topic sentence and circle your transitions.

★ **Challenge:** Write a two-paragraph informative piece about how something in your community is built or made (a house, a garden, a road, a quilt, or a meal). Give each paragraph its own topic sentence and main idea, use at least four different transition words, and end the second paragraph with a concluding sentence that wraps up both.

Looking Ahead: Week 13: Figurative language and poetry. You will explore similes, metaphors and personification in original poems set in a mountain village in Peru.

KCE PATHWAYS · GRADES 4-5 · UNIT 2: THE NEXT LEVEL · WEEK 6 · SOCIAL STUDIES

The Colonies and Who Built Them

Name: _____ **Date:** _____

PRE-LESSON WARM-UP · DO THIS BEFORE YOUR COMPUTER LESSON

What Do I Already Know?

Write what you know right now. Guesses are fine; this is your starting point.

1. What have you heard about Jamestown, Plymouth or Pocahontas? Write two things.

2. Who was already living on the land where the English built their colonies? Write what you know or guess.

3. Prediction: Why might an Indigenous nation choose to trade with colonists? Why might it choose to resist them?

4. Guess: Why would a colony need many workers? What kinds of work would they do?

5. Write one question you have about the first colonies.

KCE PATHWAYS · GRADES 4-5 · UNIT 2: THE NEXT LEVEL · WEEK 6 · SOCIAL STUDIES

The Colonies and Who Built Them

Name: _____ **Date:** _____

POST-LESSON CHALLENGE · DO THIS AFTER YOUR COMPUTER LESSON

What Did I Learn?

Use evidence from today's lesson. Write in complete sentences.

1. Using John Rolfe's letter as evidence, explain how the first Africans came to Virginia in 1619 and what the letter shows about Rolfe's point of view.

2. Choose Matoaka (Pocahontas), Massasoit or Anthony Johnson. Tell that person's story honestly in two or three sentences.

3. Compare William Penn's treaties with the 1737 Walking Purchase. How were they different?

4. Who benefited from Virginia's tobacco, and who paid the cost?

★ **Challenge:** Many old books call Plymouth's 1621 harvest feast "the first Thanksgiving" and show only friendly neighbors. Write a more complete caption for that picture, using two facts from today's lesson.

Looking Ahead: Next week we study how slavery grew in the colonies and how enslaved Africans resisted and kept their cultures alive. Bring this question: how could a colony's laws make slavery last from one generation to the next?